

History of Akbar (2-Page Notes)

Introduction

Akbar (1542–1605), also known as Jalal-ud-din Muhammad Akbar, was the third Mughal emperor. He ruled from 1556 to 1605 and is regarded as one of the greatest rulers in Indian history. His reign strengthened the Mughal Empire through military expansion, efficient administration, and policies of religious tolerance.

Early Life and Accession

Akbar was born at Umarkot in present-day Pakistan. He became emperor at the age of 13 after the death of his father, Humayun. Initially, Bairam Khan served as his guardian and regent until Akbar took full control of the empire.

Major Achievements

Akbar expanded the empire across much of northern and central India. He introduced the Mansabdari system, improved revenue administration with the help of Raja Todar Mal, encouraged trade, and maintained a strong military.

Religious Policy

Akbar promoted harmony among different religions. He abolished the jizya tax for non-Muslims, invited scholars of various faiths for discussions at the Ibadat Khana, and introduced the idea of Din-i Ilahi, a spiritual order emphasizing ethical values.

Administration and Culture

Akbar appointed capable officials regardless of religion. His court included the famous Navratnas (Nine Gems), such as Birbal, Tansen, and Abul Fazl. Art, architecture, literature, and music flourished during his reign. Fatehpur Sikri was built as his capital for a period.

Legacy

Akbar died in 1605 and was succeeded by his son Jahangir. He is remembered for his vision, administrative reforms, military success, and efforts to create unity among diverse communities. His reign is considered a golden age of the Mughal Empire.

Exam Point 1: Akbar's reign is important because of central administration, land revenue reforms, religious tolerance, military organization, cultural patronage, diplomatic alliances with Rajputs, and long-term political stability.

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